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Trump returns to the White House or Harris breaks the ultimate glass ceiling and is sworn in as the first woman President of the US, it's going to be a moment in history. Either way, a rather apt souvenir, I feel.

Washington, DC, is quite charming with its wide roads, large open green spaces, and lack of skyscrapers. President George Washington chose the exact site along the Potomac River, and the city was officially founded in 1790 after both Maryland and Virginia ceded land to this new "district," to be distinct from the rest of the states. The new territory was named District of Columbia (DC) to honour explorer Christopher Columbus, while the city was named after the first President of the US.

On a tour of the Capitol, arguably the most culturally and historically important building in the US, which has been home to the Congress since 1800, I admire the 287-ft-high cast iron dome modelled after the dome of St Peter's Basilica in Vatican City. It is adorned with a fresco that depicts gods and goddesses intermingled with Washington and other American heroes. The guided tour showcases various aspects of the Capitol, with the highlight being the National Statutory Hall, where statues of two prominent figures from each state are displayed. However, not all 100 statues are present, as engineers soon discovered

**IN 2023, OVER 165,000 INDI-
ANS TRAVELLED TO WASH-
INGTON, DC AND SPENT A
TOTAL OF \$287,400,000**

that the weight of the many marble statues exceeded the floor's load-bearing capacity, thereby threatening its structure. Consequently, some statues were moved elsewhere. Currently, there are only a handful of statues of notable women; hopefully, there will be more in the future.

Washington, DC, is dotted with buildings from which the government of the country functions. Thanks to Hollywood, we are familiar with most of these buildings. But seeing one up close is truly an experience. Every Thursday evening, the Library of Congress's Thomas Jefferson Building opens its doors to the general public for an exceptional gathering in town. Visitors are encouraged to partake in happy hour